

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/10: 1. Control question and conceptual axes

NOTIONS OF GOD

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What kind of reality is called “God”, and how is it related to humans and the world?

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nature: personal / impersonal / transpersonal

attributes: power / knowledge / goodness / eternity / simplicity

relation: God-world / God-human / transcendence / immanence

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NATURE AXIS: personal <-> impersonal | RELATION AXIS: transcendent <-> immanent

cataphatic affirmation + apophatic negation -> analogical control

too much affirmation = anthropomorphism | too much negation = empty God-talk.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/10: 2. Western relation models

WESTERN NOTIONS

- +> MONOTHEISM: one supreme God | POLYTHEISM: several genuine deities
- +> HENOTHEISM: one addressed as supreme | MONOLATRY: one worshipped
- +> THEISM: personal necessary Creator; distinct, sustaining, providential
- +> DEISM: creation -> natural law -> withdrawal; miracles/revelation weakened
- +> PANTHEISM: God and all-inclusive reality are one (not a physical aggregate)
- +> PANENTHEISM: world is in God, but God exceeds world
- ROLES: creator | sustainer | providential ruler | moral governor |
ground of being | absolute
- +> PROCESS/DIPOLAR GOD
 - abstract pole: eternal possibilities + stable character
 - consequent pole: receives changing world and experience
 - persuasion protects freedom, but revises omnipotence and immutability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/10: 3. Divine attributes under coherence pressure

ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence | omniscience | goodness | eternity
 immutability | simplicity | necessity | aseity | personhood
timeless action -> temporal effects; contingency remains pressured
immutability -> constancy, but real response/personality is difficult
personhood -> analogical intelligence/will/love, not body or male gender | personhood
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omnipotence -> logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power
foreknowledge vs freedom -> Boethius | Ockham | Molinism | open theism
goodness + power + knowledge + evil -> joint compatibility pressure
simplicity -> no parts; essence = existence; attributes not separable components
objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/10: 4. Spinoza: Deus sive Natura

DEUS SIVE NATURA -> ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

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ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression
humans know Thought and Extension

MODES: finite minds and bodies
depend on the one substance

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everything follows necessarily; God does not choose to create

radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature

objection: personality, providence and free will disappear

reply: freedom = self-determined action from one's own nature, not arbitrary choice.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/10: 5. Advaita: nirguṇa, saguṇa and vivarta

ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN

+-> NIRGUṆA: beyond limiting predicates; pāramārthika; Sat-Cit-Ānanda

+-> SAGUṆA ĪŚVARA: personal Lord; creator/ruler; vyāvahārika; devotion

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Brahman + māyā -> experienced world through VIVARTA, apparent transformation

rope appears snake; Brahman undergoes no real change

ĀTMAN = BRAHMAN -> liberation knows an already-existing identity

TRAP: anirvacanīya properly marks māyā/world appearance, not nirguṇa Brahman itself.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/10: 6. Rāmānuja: organic unity

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA -> personal saguṇa Brahman, Nārāyaṇa

CIT (selves) + ACIT (matter) = real qualifications of Brahman

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ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRĪ: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller

APṚTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity

God = material and efficient cause; world is real PARIṆĀMA

jīva -> dependence -> bhakti -> prapatti -> liberation

objection: do bodily defects taint God? reply: defects belong to controlled body.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/10: 7. Nyāya and Hindu divine plurality

NYĀYA PERSONAL GOD (ĪŚVARA): one, eternal, omniscient, incorporeal

God is efficient cause; eternal atoms are material causes

karma/adṛṣṭa -> divine coordination -> fitting results; selves remain distinct

INDIAN BOUNDARY: Yoga special self | Mīmāṃsā/Sāṃkhya no required creator |

Buddhism/Jainism religious without omnipotent creator

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“IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?”

polytheism | henotheism | kathenotheism | monotheism | monism

Ṛgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously

verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise, sectarian supremacy and

Upaniṣadic monism coexist; one label cannot exhaust all levels.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/10: 8. Comparative God-world-human matrix

SYSTEM	GOD-WORLD	GOD-HUMAN
Theism	creator and sustainer	worship, providence, grace
Deism	creator who withdraws	remote rational source
Spinoza	God = Nature	person is finite mode
Advaita	world is vivarta	ātman = Brahman
Rāmānuja	world is God's real body	distinct yet inseparably dependent
Nyāya	God orders eternal atoms	distinct soul under moral governance

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ultimate cause need not be physical: spatial/material dependence limits ultimacy;
pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/10: 9. Examiner traps and PYQ routes

TRAPS: personal != anthropomorphic/bodily/male | transcendent != spatially remote
immanent != pantheistic | pantheism != panentheism | nirguṇa != non-existent
apr̥thak-siddhi != identity | Nyāya God = efficient cause | monism != monotheism
analogy/symbol permit real reference without finite or gendered literalism

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PYQ ROUTES

personal/impersonal -> theism + Spinoza + saguṇa/nirguṇa

Spinoza -> substance -> attributes -> modes -> necessity -> criticism

Rāmānuja -> cit/acit -> body-soul -> apr̥thak-siddhi -> devotion

freedom/God -> foreknowledge problem -> named solutions -> qualified verdict.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/10: 10. Answer spine and qualified conclusion

define exact God-concept -> state metaphysical model

-> explain God-world and God-human relations -> use exact school terminology

-> strongest objection -> strongest reply -> same-axis comparison

-> qualified philosophical verdict

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God is a family of models: perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or intelligent ordering. Adequacy turns on nature + attributes + relations + coherence: whether ultimacy best preserves agency, unity, devotion, independence, moral order and intelligibility without contradiction.